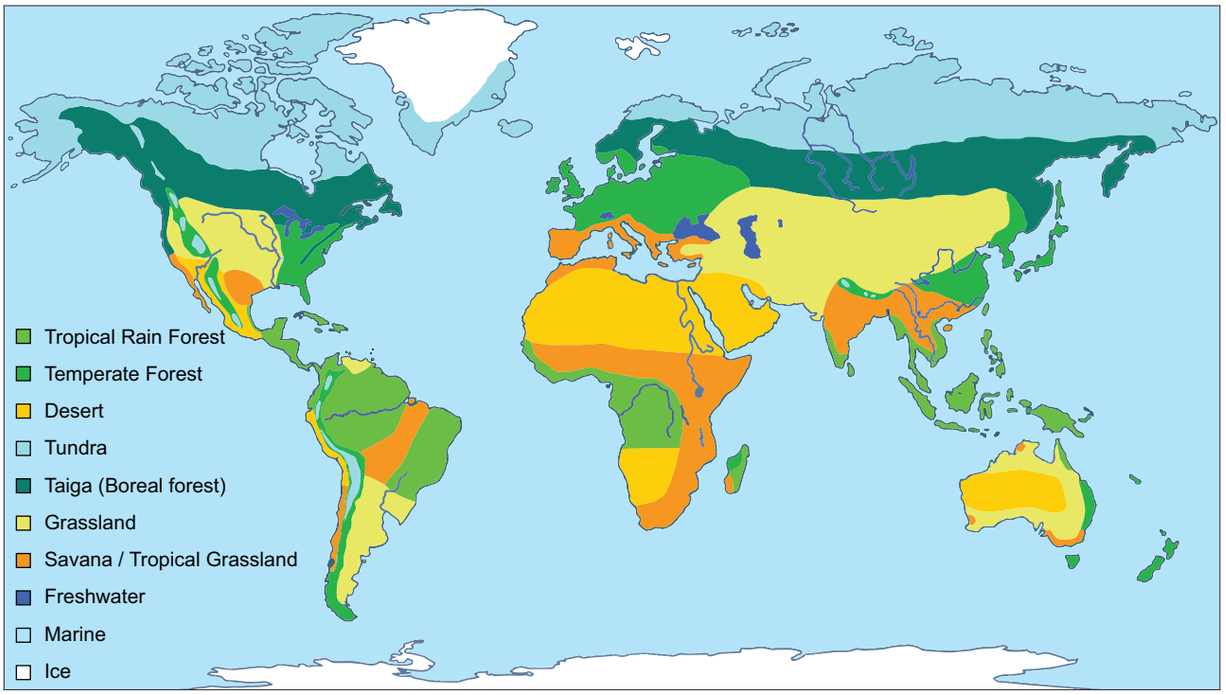


Fig. 11.4 Biomes and their geographical distribution

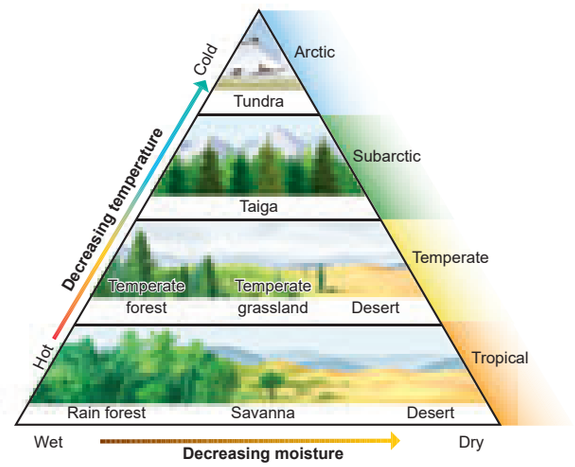


Fig. 11.5 Biomes can be broadly classified as Aquatic biomes and Terrestrial biomes

Aquatic biomes of earth

1. Freshwater (Lakes, ponds, rivers)
2. Brackish water (Estuaries / Wetlands)
3. Marine (Coral reefs, pelagic zones and abyssal zones)

Terrestrial biomes

These are large communities of plants and animals that occupy a distinct region. They include grassland, tundra, desert, tropical rainforest, and deciduous and coniferous forests. Terrestrial biomes are distinguished primarily by their predominant vegetation, and are mainly determined by climate, which in turn, determines the organisms inhabiting them. These include the keystone species and indicator species which are unique to their respective biomes. The terrestrial biomes are a source of food, O_2 and act as CO_2 sink, apart from the climate regulatory role.

Major Biomes of the Earth

Tundra biome, Taiga biome, Grassland biome, Alpine biome, Forest biome and Desert biome.

TUNDRA BIOME

- This is the almost treeless plain in the northern parts of Asia, Europe and North America.
- Winters are long with little daylight, Summers are short, with long daylight hours.
- Precipitation is less than 250 mm per year. It is a zone of permafrost.

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